

MVP complete, awaiting the merge gate

Waves 1–3 are delivered and integrated on `develop`. The plugin can configure a mail provider, send through it, record what happened, and diagnose it when it fails. What remains before `main` is verification on a clean WordPress site — not code.

RECOMMENDATION

Hold the merge until the manual clean-site checklist in `docs/RELEASE-CHECKLIST.md` is signed off. Every automated gate is green; nothing in the automated suite covers install, upgrade or uninstall on a live site.

CODE READY

QA PENDING

657 PHPUnit tests passing 1,311 assertions · PHP 8.2.12 · no warnings	0 WPCS violations Production scope: plugin root, <code>includes/</code>, <code>admin/</code>
108 Commits ahead of <code>main</code> 32 merged pull requests · 5 contributors	22.2k Lines added across 119 files 61 production PHP files · 38 test files

How the MVP was built

Three delivery waves, each one gated on the previous. The order matters: nothing could be diagnosed until mail was being sent and logged, and nothing could be scored until the checks produced evidence.

WAVE 1

7 Jul – 19 Aug

Foundation and transport

- Modular-monolith bootstrap: service container, PSR-4 autoloading with a source-tree fallback, and the `scalyn_mail_relay_booted` extension point.
- Seven granular capabilities and versioned `dbDelta()` migrations behind a DB-version gate.
- Admin shell: Dashboard and Setup Wizard framework.
- SMTP provider built on WordPress-bundled PHPMailer, behind `ProviderInterface`.

WAVE 2

21 Aug – 25 Aug

The vertical slice

- Wizard wired to a live backend: connection verification and test send, neither persisting nor echoing credentials.
- Mail log and append-only timeline, correlated by `message_uuid`.
- Email Logs screen with detail view; latest result surfaced on the Dashboard.
- Logging repositories registered as shared container services.

WAVE 3

27 Aug – 4 Sep

Diagnostics, scoring and hardening

- SPF, MX, DKIM and DMARC DNS checks; SMTP reachability, STARTTLS and certificate probe.
- Deterministic failure classifier mapping transport errors to stable categories with remediation.
- Explainable health score derived from diagnostic results and recent mail history.
- `POST /wp-json/scalyn-mail-relay/v1/diagnostics/run`, gated on `RUN_DIAGNOSTICS`.
- Release hardening: capability revocation on uninstall, dead cron removed, packaging boundary.

What ships in 0.1.0

Setup wizard

COMPLETE

Five steps: choose provider → SMTP settings → connection test → test email → verification. Progress is derived from persisted configuration state rather than session position, so a half-finished setup resumes where it actually stands. Every state-changing step is capability- and nonce-checked.

WizardController

SetupStepIndicator

provider verification state

Provider configuration

COMPLETE

One built-in SMTP provider behind `ProviderInterface`, registered through Core so additional providers are an addition rather than a rewrite. The connection test and test send return a normalized `SendResult`; failures are classified into stable categories carrying remediation text.

SmtpProvider

MailDispatcher

FailureClassifier

TransportFailureCategory

Email logging

COMPLETE

Every dispatch writes a normalized log row plus an append-only timeline, joined by a shared UUID. The Logs screen paginates, filters and searches, and is responsive down to phone width. Full message bodies are never stored — persisted data is limited to metadata and allowlisted timeline fields.

scalyn_mail_logs

scalyn_mail_timeline

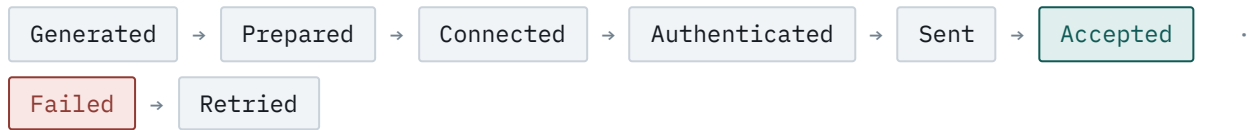
MailEventSubscriber

Diagnostics COMPLETE

Six checks across DNS and transport, each returning an immutable result with status, severity, evidence, impact and a recommended action. Runs persist under a shared run UUID and feed a health score whose every contribution traces back to a specific check. The SMTP probe never authenticates, and reports *unknown* rather than *fail* when a transient error leaves no real evidence.

SPF MX DKIM DMARC SMTP/TLS HealthScorer

The claim the product refuses to make



Accepted is not Delivered. The lifecycle terminates at *Accepted*: the provider acknowledged the message. Inbox placement is not observable from the sending side, so the UI never claims it. A *Delivered* state would require out-of-band provider or webhook evidence, which is post-MVP scope. This is why the timeline carries an accepted-status disclaimer instead of a green checkmark.

Verification evidence

Run locally on this branch, 4 September 2026. Commands are the ones CI runs.

GATE	COMMAND	RESULT	STATUS
Unit tests	<code>composer test</code>	OK – 657 tests, 1,311 assertions	PASS
Coding standards	<code>phpcs --standard=phpcs.xml.dist</code>	0 errors, 0 warnings	PASS
Syntax	<code>composer lint:php</code>	Clean across tracked PHP files	PASS
Schema	<code>Migrator::migrate()</code>	6 tables at the site prefix	PASS
Clean-site install / upgrade / uninstall	Manual – RELEASE-CHECKLIST §3–5	Not yet executed on a clean WordPress	PENDING
Security & privacy sweep	Manual – RELEASE-CHECKLIST §6	Capability, nonce and credential-leak review	PENDING
Live provider regression	Manual – RELEASE-CHECKLIST §7	Real SMTP success and failure paths	PENDING

Note on scope: the WPCS ruleset covers the plugin entry point, `uninstall.php`, `includes/` and `admin/`. Test files are deliberately outside it and do carry style violations; that is a standing decision, not a regression introduced by this branch.

Known limitations, accepted deliberately

All four are recorded with rationale in `ADR-0002` . None block the release criteria; each was decided explicitly rather than silently implemented under a “no new features” freeze.

Log retention is inert

DEFERRED

`log_retention_days` is stored and sanitized, but no purge job runs. Logs, timelines, diagnostic results and health scores grow without bound. High-volume operators must prune manually. This is the first post-MVP ticket.

No dead cron

FIXED

The daily `cleanup_logs` and `run_daily_diagnostics` events had no listeners. Rather than ship an event that fires and does nothing, activation now schedules none and clears events left by earlier installs.

Destructive uninstall is programmatic

DEFERRED

Data is retained on uninstall by default. Opting into deletion means setting the option via WP-CLI, a filter or a deploy script — there is no admin checkbox in 0.1.0. Uninstall now also revokes every granted capability from every role.

Probes may reach private ranges

ACCEPTED RISK

The SMTP probe does not block loopback or RFC 1918 targets, because self-hosted relays are legitimate. Bounded by administrator-level capabilities, the SMTP protocol itself, 5-second timeouts, and disclosure limited to capability flags and certificate metadata. Revisit if `RUN_DIAGNOSTICS` is ever granted without `MANAGE_SETTINGS` .

Multisite is unsupported in 0.1.0: `uninstall.php` operates on a single `$wpdb->prefix` and would strand tables on secondary sites. Declared in the README, the uninstall policy and the file header.

Before this reaches `main`

01	Fresh-install QA on a clean WordPress 6.5 and current Six tables created, three options written, seven capabilities on Administrator, no notices in <code>debug.log</code> , wizard completes end to end.	OPEN
02	Upgrade-in-place test from an earlier build Pre-existing rows readable, no data loss through <code>dbDelta()</code> , no orphaned cron events.	OPEN
03	Both uninstall modes verified Retain leaves everything intact; delete drops all six tables, all options and every capability, touching nothing owned by other plugins.	OPEN

04	Credential-leak sweep across every surface No password, key, token or authorization header in log tables, <code>raw_result</code> , REST responses, admin HTML or <code>debug.log</code> .	OPEN
05	Live SMTP regression, success and failure Test email delivered with matching log and timeline UUIDs; wrong host and wrong port fail safely with no credential in the message.	OPEN
06	Accessibility and manual UI pass on all four screens Dashboard, Diagnostics, Email Logs, Providers — plus the wizard, at desktop and phone widths.	OPEN
07	Package and tag Verify <code>.gitattributes</code> export boundary excludes tests, docs and tooling from the archive; confirm version agreement across the plugin header, <code>SCALYN_MAIL_RELAY_VERSION</code> and <code>package.json</code> .	OPEN

What comes after

Deliberately out of the MVP and kept separate until 0.1.0 is stable in the field: log retention enforcement (first ticket), the destructive-uninstall admin UI, multisite support, alerting and notification workflows, additional API mail providers, agency and white-label management, centralized monitoring, and AI-assisted remediation. Foundation tables exist for alerts and audit logs; that is schema, not shipped behavior.

Branch `fix/diagnostics-qa-followups` HEAD `daad0cb` WordPress 6.5+ · PHP 8.2+ · MySQL 8 / MariaDB 10.6
Single-site only